



TEACHER & COORDINATOR

Run-of-Show Guide

How to run a warm, smooth, fully-kosher Korean cooking workshop.



1 The big picture

This is a 3-hour hands-on workshop in Hashmonaim. Participants cook at their own stations — some solo, some as a date night, some with friends — you guide from the front and float between tables, and everyone sits down to eat what they made. Your job is part chef, part host, part timekeeper. The mood: relaxed, playful and welcoming — nobody should feel judged on their knife skills.

Run one of the two ready-made menus (Set 1 · Sizzle & Comfort, or Set 2 · Spice & Noodles), or mix your own 5–6 dishes. Always front-load anything that needs rising or marinating time.

☆ **Keep one golden rule visible at all times:** meat and pareve never mix.

Tools: participants bring their own large knife, cutting board and apron. Have spares on hand. **Money:** 350 NIS per person covers the food they cook; soft drinks, beer and saké are purchased separately at the meal. Payment via Bit, Paybox or cash.

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Before the event

CHOOSE THE MENU

- A comfortable session is 4–5 dishes: one or two appetizers, one salad/side, one or two mains, and one dessert.
- Balance the kashrut load: if you run a meat main, keep most other dishes pareve. Mark each dish MEAT or PAREVE on your plan.
- Kimchi is a lovely add-on at any session — quick to assemble and goes home as a gift.

SHOP (USE THE BOOKLET'S MASTER LIST)

- Shop only for the dishes you chose — the master list is flagged by dish number.
- Buy kosher-certified gochujang, gochugaru, soy sauce and sesame oil (East & West, Tel Aviv, or online).
- Pre-portion tricky items (thin beef, wrappers, tteok, glass noodles) the day before so stations are grab-and-go.

SET UP THE ROOM

- One station per cook (or pair): mixing bowls, non-stick pan, spatula, measuring spoons, paper towels, a small bowl of water for sealing dumplings.

KEY

Colour-code by kashrut. One colour of board/tools/pans for MEAT, a different colour for PAREVE. A coloured card on each station prevents 90% of mistakes.

- A central 'pantry' table with labelled, pre-measured shared ingredients. Keep meat and pareve serving spoons separate even here.
- Set out booklets, aprons, and a jar per person for the take-home kimchi (with our label on top).

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Run-of-show

A 3-hour flow following Set 1. Adjust to your menu — the order of operations matters more than the exact clock.

0:00–0:15 Welcome

- ♥ Greet people at the door, check everyone has an apron, point them to a station.
- ♥ Give the two house rules warmly: taste as you go, and keep MEAT and PAREVE tools completely separate. Add a 30-second safety word.

“Annyeonghaseyo and welcome to Batya’s Kosher Korean Kitchen! For the next three hours you’re going to cook a whole Korean spread — and then eat every bite of it. No experience needed. If you can stir and flip, you’re going to do great.”

0:15–0:35 Start the slow things

- ♥ Lead everyone through the dough and marinade FIRST so they rest while you cook other dishes.
- ♥ Salt the cabbage and pack everyone’s take-home kimchi jars now so they soften and ferment.

“Before anything else, let’s get our Hotteok dough resting and our Bulgogi marinating — these need a little quiet time. While they relax, so do we — onto the fun stuff.”

0:35–1:05 Appetizers + salad

- ♥ Demo each dish at the front for 2 minutes, then let people do it. Float and encourage.
- ♥ These are the first things they taste — make a little moment of it.

“Watch me once, then it’s all yours. Don’t aim for perfect — aim for golden and delicious. A wobbly pancake still tastes amazing.”

1:05–1:50 The main event

- ♥ Remind the meat/pareve split out loud before mains start.
- ♥ Float constantly: heat management is where beginners struggle. Nudge pans hotter, stop overcrowding.

“Mains time. If you’re on a meat dish, use your own knife and board and the red-tagged pan only. Get that pan properly hot before the beef goes in; we want a sizzle, not a stew.”

1:50–2:15 Plate the savoury spread

- ♥ Have everyone arrange what they’ve made so far, taste, and adjust seasoning.
- ♥ Tidy stations for dessert.

“Look at this spread — you made all of it. Taste as you go and fix the seasoning to your liking; you’re the chef now.”

2:15–2:40 Dessert

♥ Bring back the risen Hotteok dough with a little drama. Fill, press, fry.

“Remember that dough we started? Look how puffy it got. Fill it, press it, fry it — and please, let it cool before you bite. That brown-sugar centre is molten.”

2:40–3:00 Sit down & feast

♥ Help everyone plate up. Encourage photos. Do a short toast.

“You made all of this. Masitge deuseyo: eat well! Take photos, swap bites, and don’t forget your kimchi jar on the way out.”

4 Teaching each dish

Pajeon	Batter should be thin like cream; keep the oil generous and the pan hot for crispy edges. Press flat after pouring.
Mandu	Squeeze the cabbage well or the filling weeps. Only 1 tsp filling per wrapper — overfilling is the #1 beginner mistake. Seal fully.
Gyeran-mari	Low heat is everything — no browning. Roll while the top is still slightly wet so layers fuse.
Oi-muchim	Salt and drain the cucumbers or the salad turns watery. Toss just before serving.
Sesame Spinach	Blanch 30–45 sec only, shock in ice water, and SQUEEZE hard — wet spinach makes a soggy dish.
Bulgogi	Slice the beef thin (freeze 30 min first). Very hot pan, single layer, don't crowd — caramelize, don't steam.
Dak-galbi	Sweet-potato slices go in first (they take longest). Make sure chicken is fully cooked — no pink — before serving.
Bibimbap	Keep each vegetable seasoned separately for colour and balance; mix only at the very end.
Japchae	Don't overcook the glass noodles; snip them so they're easier to toss. Toss off heat so they stay glossy.
Dubu Jorim	Pat the tofu really dry and brown it well before saucing, or it falls apart. Spoon the sauce over as it simmers.
Hotteok	Start the dough early. Oil your hands — sticky dough is normal. Warn about the lava-hot filling every single time.
Honey Tteok	Don't over-boil the tteok or it gets gummy; toss in honey while warm so the sesame sticks.
Kimchi	Salt, rinse well, glove up for the paste. Pack tight, leave headspace, lid on. Remind: 1–2 days at room temp, then fridge.

5 Keeping it kosher

- ☆ MEAT and PAREVE never share a board, knife, pan, bowl, or serving spoon. Colour-coding handles this — enforce it kindly but firmly.
- ☆ No dairy in the cooking area during a meat-inclusive session; all dessert and pareve recipes are deliberately dairy-free.
- ☆ Use kosher-certified gochujang, gochugaru, soy sauce and sesame oil. Never fish sauce, anchovy/dashi stock, or oyster sauce — the recipes swap these.
- ☆ Check leafy vegetables (spinach, napa cabbage, scallions) for insects, as required, before use.
- ☆ If a tool is used by mistake on the wrong category, set it aside and switch the cook to a clean one — no drama, just reset.

6 Safety

- ♥ Hot oil for Pajeon and Hotteok: keep handles turned in, never leave a hot pan unattended, keep a lid nearby.
- ♥ Frying hotteok spits — have cooks lower items in gently, away from themselves.
- ♥ Sharp knives: remind the 'claw' grip; go slow. You're not running a knife-skills class.
- ♥ The hotteok filling and any bubbling pan are burn risks — say 'let it cool' often.
- ♥ Know where the fire blanket / extinguisher and first-aid kit are before guests arrive.

7 Troubleshooting on the fly

Pancake won't crisp

→ Oil too shallow or pan not hot enough — add oil, raise heat, press flat, wait.

Dumplings burst

→ Overfilled or not sealed — less filling, wet the edge, pinch firmly.

Omelette browning

→ Heat too high — drop it and add a touch of oil.

Salad watery

→ Didn't drain the salted cucumber/spinach — squeeze/drain and re-dress.

Beef steaming, not searing

→ Pan not hot or overcrowded — work in smaller batches, hotter pan.

Too spicy

→ Add a little sugar/honey and more vegetables to mellow the gochujang.

Dough didn't rise

→ Water too hot or yeast old — give it more time in a warmer spot; it'll still fry up fine.

Running behind

→ Drop one main, or finish a slow dish family-style at the front while everyone plates the rest.

8 Wrap-up

- ✿ Send everyone home with: their participant booklet, their sealed kimchi jar (with our label), and a photo from the night if you can.
- ✿ Invite them to tag the class when they post — those plated photos are your best advertising.
- ✿ **Reset checklist:** separate and wash meat vs. pareve tools, restock pantry, top up oils, refill jars and aprons for next time.

*Keep it warm, keep it kosher, keep it fun.
Masitge deuseyo! ♥*